“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 17

A Brief Description of the Pastimes of Young Manhood

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

1 “I worship Śrī Caitanya, whose deeds are free and wondrous. By His grace even the yavanas, chanting the names of Kṛṣṇa, become saintly.”[1]

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 I have summed up the pastimes of His youth; now I shall outline, in order, those of His young manhood.

4 “In His young manhood Gaura shone in His play — in learning and beauty, in fine attire and its enjoyments, in dance and kīrtana, and in the gift of love and the holy name.”[2]

5 As He entered young manhood, ornaments graced every limb of His body, and He wore splendid clothes and finery, garlands and sandal paste.

6 In the pride of His learning He took no account of anyone; He defeated all the paṇḍitas and began to teach.

7 Under the pretext of a disorder of the vital airs (*vāyu*), He revealed His love, and with the devotees He enjoyed many pastimes.[3]

8 Then the Lord went to Gayā, and there He met Īśvara Purī.

9 After His initiation His love was revealed, and when He came home again, He gave Himself to the play of love.[4]

10 He gave love to Śacī; then He met Advaita, and Advaita beheld His universal form.[5]

11 Then Śrīvāsa performed the Lord's abhiṣeka, and the Lord, seated on the couch, revealed His majesty.[6]

12 Then Nityānanda Svarūpa came, and when He met the Lord, He was granted the vision of the six-armed form.[7]

13 First the Lord showed Him the six-armed form, holding conch, disc, club and lotus, the Śārṅga bow and the flute.

14 Then He became four-armed, His body bent in three places; with two hands He played the flute, and in the other two He held the conch and disc.

15 And then He was simply two-armed, with the flute at His lips: the son of Vraja's king, dark of body and dressed in yellow.

16 Then Nityānanda Gosāñi performed the Vyāsa-pūjā, and the Lord, absorbed in the mood of Nityānanda, took up the club (*muṣala*).[8]

17 Then Śacī saw the two brothers as Rāma and Kṛṣṇa, and after that the Lord delivered Jagāi and Mādhāi.[9]

18 Then for seven praharas the Lord remained absorbed in ecstasy, and the devotees, wherever they were, beheld Him in a special way.[10]

19 In Murāri's house the Lord became absorbed in the mood of Varāha, and climbing onto Murāri's shoulders, He danced in the courtyard.[11]

20 Then He ate the raw rice that Śuklāmbara had begged, and He explained the meaning of the verse *harer nāma*.[12]

21 "The name of Hari, the name of Hari, the name of Hari alone! In the age of Kali there is no other way, there is no other way, there is no other way." (Bṛhan-nāradīya Purāṇa, 38.126)[13]

22 In the age of Kali, Kṛṣṇa descends in the form of the holy name, and through the name the whole world is delivered.

23 For emphasis the words *harer nāma* are said three times, and the word *eva* is added again to make dull people understand.

24 The word *kevala* ("alone") makes it certain once more, and rules out knowledge, yoga, austerity, karma and all the rest.

25 Whoever thinks otherwise has no deliverance: that is why "there is not" is said three times with *eva*.

26 Thinking oneself lower than the grass, one should always chant the name, seeking no honour for oneself and giving honour to others.

27 A Vaiṣṇava should be as tolerant as a tree; scolded or beaten, he should say nothing to anyone.

28 A tree says nothing even when it is cut down; it may wither and die, yet it never asks for water.

29 So a Vaiṣṇava should ask nothing of anyone; he should live on what comes unasked, or eat greens and fruit.

30 He should always chant the name and be content with whatever comes. Such conduct nourishes the dharma of devotion.

31 "Lower than a blade of grass, more tolerant than a tree, seeking no honour and offering honour to others, one should always sing the glories of Hari." (Śikṣāṣṭaka, 3)[14]

32 With arms upraised I say: listen, everyone! String this verse on the thread of the holy name and wear it around your neck.

33 Live by this verse, as the Lord has ordered, and you will surely attain the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.[15]

34 Then for a whole year the Lord held saṅkīrtana every night in Śrīvāsa's house.

35 They sang with the doors shut, deeply absorbed; the unbelievers came to mock, but could not get in.

36 Hearing the kīrtana from outside, they burned with envy and devised all kinds of schemes to trouble Śrīvāsa.

37–38 There was a brāhmaṇa named Gopāla Cāpāla, a foul-mouthed babbler and the chief of the unbelievers. One night he took all the articles for the worship of Bhavānī and smeared the ground at Śrīvāsa's door to prepare a place for the rite.[16]

39 On a banana leaf he set out oḍa flowers, turmeric, vermilion, red sandal paste and rice.

40 He set a pot of wine beside them and went home, and in the morning Śrīvāsa saw it all.

41 He called the respectable people of the town and, laughing heartily, said to them all:

42 “Every night I worship Bhavānī. See my glory, good brāhmaṇas!”

43 Then all those good people cried out in dismay: “What wicked man has done such a thing here?”

44 They sent for a sweeper to clear it all away, and had the place cleansed with water and cow dung.

45 Three days later Gopāla Cāpāla was struck with leprosy all over his body, and blood streamed from his sores.

46 Worms covered his whole body and gnawed at him without rest; the pain was unbearable, and his heart burned with agony.

47 He sat under a tree at a ghāṭa on the Ganges, and one day, seeing the Lord, he spoke to Him:

48 “By village kinship I am Your maternal uncle. See, nephew, how leprosy torments me.

49 You have descended to deliver all people, and I am in great misery. Deliver me!”

50 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu grew angry and spoke threatening words to him:

51 “You sinner, you hater of devotees! I will not deliver you. For ten million births I will have the worms devour you like this.

52 You made it look as though Śrīvāsa worshipped Bhavānī; for ten million births you will fall into the hell of Raurava.[17]

53 I have come to destroy the unbelievers, and when they are gone I shall spread devotion everywhere.”

54 With these words the Lord went to bathe in the Ganges, and the sinner went on suffering, unable to die.

55–56 After the Lord had taken sannyāsa and gone to Nīlācala, He once came from there to the village of Kuliyā. Then the sinner took shelter of Him, and the Lord, moved to compassion, gave him good counsel:[18]

57 “You have offended Śrīvāsa Paṇḍita. Go to him, and if he shows you his grace,

58 you will be freed from this sin, if you never act in such a way again.”

59 So the brāhmaṇa came and took shelter of Śrīvāsa, and by his grace he was freed from his sin.

60 Another brāhmaṇa came to see the kīrtana, but the door was shut and he could not get in.

61 He went home with a heavy heart, and the next day, seeing the Lord at the Ganges, he said to Him:[19]

62 “I will curse You, for You have grieved me!” And tearing his sacred thread, the fierce, foul-mouthed man cursed Him:

63 “May Your worldly happiness be destroyed!” Hearing the curse, Mahāprabhu was filled with delight.

64 Whoever hears with faith the story of the Lord’s curse is delivered from the curse of a brāhmaṇa.[20]

65 To Mukunda Datta the Lord gave His grace in the form of punishment, and so dispelled all the dejection of his heart.[21]

66 The Lord honoured Ācārya Gosāñi as His guru, and this made the Ācārya very unhappy.

67 So the Ācārya, by design, began to expound the path of knowledge, and the Lord in anger treated Him with disrespect.

68 Then Ācārya Gosāñi was filled with joy, and the Lord, abashed, showed Him His grace.[22]

69 Hearing from Murāri Gupta the glories of Rāma, the Lord wrote the name “Rāmadāsa” on his forehead.[23]

70 He drank water from Śrīdhara’s iron pot, and to all the devotees He granted the boons they desired.[24]

71 He showed His grace to Haridāsa Ṭhākura, and freed His mother from her offence against the Ācārya.[25]

72 The Lord told the devotees of the glory of the holy name, and a student who heard it explained it away as mere praise (*arthavāda*).

73 Hearing the name called an exaggeration, the Lord was pained, and He forbade everyone to look upon that man's face.[26]

74 Then He went with His companions and bathed in the Ganges in His clothes, and there He explained the glory of devotion.

75 Kṛṣṇa is not brought under control by knowledge, karma, yoga or dharma; the one thing that holds Him is the rasa of love for Him.

76 (Śrī Kṛṣṇa said:) "O Uddhava, neither yoga nor sāṅkhya, neither dharma nor study of the Vedas, neither austerity nor renunciation can win Me as intense devotion to Me does." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 11.14.20)[27]

77 The Lord said to Murāri, "You have brought Kṛṣṇa under your control," and hearing this, Murāri began to recite a verse:[28]

78 "Who am I, a poor and sinful man, and who is Kṛṣṇa, the abode of the goddess of fortune? Yet because I was born a brāhmaṇa, He embraced me in His arms!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.81.16)[29]

79 One day, tired after saṅkīrtana with all the devotees, the Lord sat down to rest.[30]

80 He planted a mango seed in the courtyard, and at once a tree sprang up and began to grow.

81 As they watched, the tree began to bear fruit, and many mangoes ripened, to everyone's wonder.

82 The Lord quickly picked two hundred mangoes, washed them and offered them to Kṛṣṇa.

83 They were red and yellow, without stone or skin, and a single fruit was enough to satisfy a man.

84 The son of Śacī was pleased to see them; He tasted them first and then fed everyone.

85 Without stone or skin, they were full of nectarean juice, and one fruit was a meal in itself.

86 So the tree bore fruit every day for twelve months, and the Vaiṣṇavas ate it, to the Lord's delight.

87 Such were the pastimes of Śacī's son, and no one but the devotees knew of them.

88 Thus for twelve months, when the kīrtana ended, the Lord held a mango festival day after day.

89 Once, while the Lord was holding kīrtana, clouds gathered, and by His own will He sent them away.[31]

90 One day the Lord told Śrīvāsa, "Read the great Thousand Names; I wish to hear them."

91 As he read, the hymn came to the name of Nṛsiṁha, and hearing it, the Lord, the abode of all virtues, became absorbed in His mood.

92 In the mood of Nṛsiṁha, the Lord took a club in His hand and ran into the town to kill the unbelievers.

93 Seeing Him in the mood of Nṛsiṁha, blazing with power, the people left the road and fled in terror.

94 Seeing their fear, the Lord came back to outer awareness; He went to Śrīvāsa's house and threw down the club.

95 Dejected, the Lord said to Śrīvāsa, "I have frightened the people. The offence is Mine."

96 Śrīvāsa said, "Whoever takes Your name is freed from millions of offences.

97 There was no offence: You delivered the people. Whoever has seen You is free from the cycle of birth and death."

98 With these words Śrīvāsa served Him, and the Lord, pleased, returned home.

99 Another day a devotee of Śiva came singing Śiva's glories; he danced in the Lord's courtyard, playing the ḍamaru drum.

100 Śacī's son was absorbed in the mood of Maheśa, and climbing onto the man's shoulders He danced for a long time.

101 Another day a beggar came for alms, and seeing the Lord dance, he began to dance too.

102 He danced with the Lord in great joy, and the Lord gave him love, so that he floated in its rasa.

103 Another day an all-knowing astrologer came, and the Lord, receiving him with honour, asked him a question:

104 "Calculate and tell Me who I was in My previous birth." Hearing the Lord's words, the astrologer began his calculations.

105 Having calculated, he saw in meditation a great effulgence, the shelter of all, of endless Vaikuṇṭhas and universes.

106 Seeing the Lord's form as the Supreme Truth, the Supreme Brahman, the Supreme Lord, the astrologer was bewildered.

107 He could say nothing and fell silent; but when the Lord asked again, he began to speak:

108 "In Your previous birth You were the supreme shelter, the complete Bhagavān, full of all majesty.

109 As You were then, so You are now; Your own nature is eternal bliss, hard to fathom."

110 The Lord smiled and said, "You have understood nothing. Before, I was a cowherd by caste.[32]

111 I was born in a cowherd's home and tended the cows, and by that merit I have now become the son of a brāhmaṇa."

112 The astrologer said, "I saw that in my meditation, but I saw majesty in it and was bewildered.

113 That form and this one I see as one; if at times I see a difference, that is Your māyā.

114 Whoever You may be, I bow to You." And the Lord rewarded him with love.

115 One day, sitting in the hall of Viṣṇu, the Lord called out, "Bring honey! Bring honey!"

116 Nityānanda Gosāñi understood the Lord's mood; He brought a pot of Ganges water and held it before the Lord.

117 Drinking the water, the Lord danced, overwhelmed, and everyone saw the pastime in which Balarāma drew the Yamunā to Himself.[33]

118 He moved with the reeling gait of Baladeva, and Ācārya Śekhara saw Him in the form of Rāma.[34]

119 Vanamālī Ācārya saw a golden plough, and all danced together, overwhelmed with bliss.[35]

120 So the dancing went on for four praharas; in the evening they all bathed in the Ganges and went home.

121 When the Lord gave His order to the townspeople, they began to hold saṅkīrtana in every house:[36]

122 "*Hari haraye namaḥ, kṛṣṇa yādavāya namaḥ, gopāla govinda rāma śrī-madhusūdana*."

123 The great sound of saṅkīrtana rose with mṛdaṅgas and karatālas, and nothing could be heard but "Hari! Hari!"

124 Hearing it, the Muslims grew angry and all came to the Kazi to complain.[37]

125 In the evening the Kazi came angrily to one house, broke the mṛdaṅga and said to the people:[38]

126 "All this time no one here has dared to follow Hindu ways openly. Now you carry on with such zeal — on whose strength, I would like to

know?[39]

127 Let no one hold kīrtana anywhere in the town. Today I forgive you and go home.

128 But if I find anyone holding kīrtana again, I will take all he owns and strip him of his caste."

129 With these words the Kazi went away, and the townspeople, in great distress, told the Lord what had happened.

130 The Lord ordered, "Go and hold kīrtana! Today I shall destroy all the Muslims."

131 They all went home and held kīrtana, but in fear of the Kazi they were not at ease, and their hearts trembled.

132 Knowing the fear in their hearts, the Lord quickly called the people together and said:

133 "Today I shall hold kīrtana throughout the town. By evening, all of you, decorate the town.

134 In the evening light lamps in every house, and we shall see what Kazi comes to stop Me!"

135 Having said this, Gaurarāya set out in the evening, and He formed the kīrtana into three groups.

136 Haridāsa danced in the first group, and in the middle one Ācārya Gosāñi danced in great joy.

137 In the last group danced Gauracandra, and Nityānanda Prabhu danced along with Him.

138 By the power of Caitanya's mercy, Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this at length in the *Caitanya-maṅgala*.[40]

139 So, holding kīrtana, He wandered through the town, and in His wandering He came to the Kazi's door.

140 The people shouted threats and made a great uproar: under Gauracandra's protection they had grown wild with boldness.

141 At the sound of the kīrtana the Kazi hid in his house, and hearing the threats and roars, he would not come out.

142 Unruly people broke into the Kazi's house and flower garden; Vṛndāvana dāsa has described this at length.

143 Then Mahāprabhu sat down at his door and sent respectable men to call the Kazi.

144 The Kazi approached from a distance, his head bowed, and the Lord received him with honour and gave him a seat.

145 The Lord said, "I have come to you as a guest, yet when you saw Me you hid. What kind of conduct is this?"

146 The Kazi said, "You came in anger, so I stayed hidden to let You grow calm.

147 Now that You are calm, I have come to meet You. How fortunate I am to receive a guest like You!

148 By village kinship Cakravartī is my uncle, and village kinship is truer than kinship of the body.[41]

149 Nīlāmbara Cakravartī is Your maternal grandfather, so by that relation You are my nephew.

150 An uncle will bear his nephew's anger, and a nephew does not hold his uncle's offences against him."

151 So the two spoke in hints, and no one could grasp the inner meaning.

152 The Lord said, "I have come to ask you a question," and the Kazi replied, "Ask whatever is on Your mind."

153 The Lord said, "You drink cow's milk, so the cow is your mother; the bull produces grain, so he is your father.

154 You kill your father and mother and eat them — what religion is this? On what authority do you commit such a sin?"

155 The Kazi said, "As You have the Vedas and Purāṇas, so we have our scripture, the book of the Koran.

156 That scripture distinguishes two paths, the path of worldly engagement and the path of renunciation, and on the path of renunciation the killing of any living being is forbidden.[42]

157 On the path of worldly engagement there is an injunction to kill cows, and if one kills by the order of scripture, there is no fear of sin.

158 Your Vedas too speak of the killing of cows, and great sages did kill them."

159 The Lord said, “The Vedas forbid the killing of cows, and therefore no Hindu kills a cow.

160 The Vedas and Purāṇas command that one may kill a living being only if one can bring it back to life.

161 So the sages would kill a worn-out old animal (*jaradgava*) and restore its life by Vedic mantras.

162 The old animal became young once more, so this was not killing but a kindness.

163 In the age of Kali the brāhmaṇas have no such power, and so now no one kills cows.

164 “In the age of Kali one should give up five things: the horse sacrifice, the cow sacrifice, sannyāsa, the offering of flesh to the forefathers, and the begetting of a son by the husband’s brother.” (Brahma-vaivarta Purāṇa, Kṛṣṇa-janma-khaṇḍa, 185.180)[43]

165 You cannot bring them back to life; all you do is kill. For you there is no escape from hell.

166 For as many thousands of years as there are hairs on a cow’s body, the killer of a cow rots in the hell of Raurava.

167 The one who gave you your scripture was himself mistaken; not knowing the essence of scripture, he gave such an order.”[44]

168 Hearing this, the Kazi was dumbstruck and could find no words. After some thought he admitted defeat and said:

169 “What You have said, Paṇḍita, is true. Our scriptures are recent and cannot stand up to reasoning.[45]

170 Our scripture is invented — I know that well; yet out of loyalty to my community I still accept it.”[46]

171 The reasoning of the yavanas’ scriptures is by nature unsound. Smiling, Mahāprabhu questioned him once more:[47]

172 “Let Me ask you one more question, uncle. Answer truly, and do not deceive Me with tricks.

173 In your town there is saṅkīrtana all the time — the din of drums and songs, singing and dancing.

174 You are the Kazi, with authority to oppose the Hindu religion; I cannot understand why you do not forbid it now.”

175 The Kazi said, “Everyone calls You Gaurahari, and by that name I too shall address You.

176 Listen, Gaurahari: if we can speak in private, I shall tell You the reason.”

177 The Lord said, “These people are My intimates. Speak plainly and have no fear.”

178–179 The Kazi began: “When I went to a Hindu’s house, broke the mṛdaṅga and forbade the kīrtana, that very night there came a most terrible lion, with the body of a man and the face of a lion, roaring mightily.[48]

180 As I lay asleep, he leapt up onto me, laughing a terrible laugh and gnashing his teeth.

181 Pressing his claws into my chest, he said in a dreadful voice, ‘I will tear your chest open in return for the mṛdaṅga!

182 You forbid My kīrtana — I will destroy you!’ Terrified, I shut my eyes and trembled.

183 Seeing my fear, the lion grew kind and said, ‘I have humbled you only to teach you a lesson.

184 That day you did no great harm, so I have forgiven you and spared your life.

185 But if you do such a thing again, I will not bear it: I will destroy you with your whole family, and the yavanas too.’

186 With these words the lion went away, but I was filled with fear. Look — here are the marks of his claws on my chest!”

187 So saying, the Kazi bared his chest, and all who heard and saw were amazed.

188 The Kazi went on: “I have told this to no one. That same day one of my men came to me[49]

189 and said, ‘I went to stop the kīrtana, and suddenly a tongue of fire struck my face.

190 My whole beard was burnt and my face was blistered.’ Every one of my men who went there told the same story.

191 Seeing all this, I was seized with great fear; now I stay at home and do not forbid the kīrtana.

192 So the kīrtana went on in the town unhindered; and hearing of it, all the Muslims came to me with a complaint:[50]

193 ‘The Hindu religion has grown beyond all bounds in the town; we hear nothing but “Hari! Hari!”’

194 Another said, ‘The Hindus cry “Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!”; they laugh and weep, dance and sing, and roll in the dust.

195 They raise an uproar with “Hari! Hari!” If the Pādśāh hears of it, you will pay for it.’[51]

196 Then I asked those Muslims, ‘That the Hindus say “Hari” is their nature — that I understand.

197 But you are Muslims: why do you take the name of the Hindus’ God all the time?’

198 One of them said, ‘I used to make fun of the Hindus. Some of them are called Kṛṣṇadāsa, some Rāmadāsa,

199 some Haridāsa, and they were forever saying “Hari! Hari!” — I thought they meant to steal someone’s wealth.[52]

200 Ever since then my tongue keeps saying “Hari! Hari!” I do not want it to, yet it says it — what can I do?’

201–202 Another said, ‘Listen — I too mocked the Hindus in this way, and since that day my tongue repeats the name of Kṛṣṇa and will not be

stopped. I do not know what spells and herbs these Hindus know!’[53]

203 When I had heard this, I sent them all home. Just then five or seven Hindu unbelievers came to me.[54]

204 They said, ‘Nimāi has broken the Hindu religion. He has started a kīrtana the like of which we have never heard.

205 When we keep the night vigil for Maṅgala-caṇḍī or Viṣahari, then dancing, singing and music are proper.

206 This Nimāi Paṇḍita used to be a good young man, but since He came back from Gayā He does everything the wrong way.

207 He sings at the top of His voice and claps His hands, and the sound of mṛdaṅgas and karatālas deafens our ears.

208 Who knows what He has eaten to go mad like this? He dances and sings, laughs and weeps, falls down, gets up and rolls on the ground.

209 His constant saṅkīrtana has driven the townspeople mad. At night we cannot sleep; we lie awake.

210 He has given up the name Nimāi and now has Himself called Gaurahari. He has ruined the Hindu religion by spreading heresy.

211 The low-born chant Kṛṣṇa’s name and rise higher and higher. For this sin Navadvīpa will be laid waste.[55]

212 In the Hindu scriptures, we know, the name of Īśvara is a great mantra; if everyone hears it, the mantra loses its power.[56]

213 You are the lord of this place, and all its people are yours. Summon Nimāi and drive Him out.’

214 Then I soothed them: ‘Go home, all of you. I will stop Him.’

215 The great God of the Hindus is Nārāyaṇa — and my heart tells me that You are He.”

216 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu smiled and, touching the Kazi, began to speak:

217 “Kṛṣṇa’s name in your mouth — this is most wonderful! Your sins are destroyed, and you have become supremely pure.[57]

218 You have spoken three names — Hari, Kṛṣṇa and Nārāyaṇa. You are most fortunate and most pious.”

219 At these words tears fell from the Kazi’s eyes, and touching the Lord’s feet, he said with deep feeling:

220 “By Your grace my evil mind is gone. Be merciful to me, so that devotion to You may abide in me.”

221 The Lord said, “I beg one gift of you: let there be no obstruction to the saṅkīrtana in Nadia.”

222 The Kazi said, “On all who are born in my line I shall lay a solemn charge (*talāk*): they shall never obstruct the kīrtana.”[58]

223 Thereupon the Lord rose, crying “Hari!”, and all the Vaiṣṇavas rose with Him, raising the sound of Hari’s name.

224 The Lord set off to go on with the kīrtana, and the Kazi walked along with Him, his heart full of joy.

225 Then the son of Śacī bade the Kazi farewell and came back to His own home, dancing all the way.

226 Thus the Lord showed His grace to the Kazi. Whoever hears of it is freed from his offences.

227 One day the Lord was dancing with Nityānanda in Śrīvāsa's house — the two brothers together.

228 Just then Śrīvāsa's son passed away, yet no grief arose in Śrīvāsa's heart.

229 The Lord made the dead son speak words of divine knowledge, and the two brothers Themselves became Śrīvāsa's sons.[59]

230 Then He gave boons to all the devotees, and He honoured Nārāyaṇī by giving her His remnants.[60]

231 A Muslim tailor used to sew Śrīvāsa's clothes, and the Lord let him see His own form.[61]

232 Crying, "I have seen! I have seen!", he went mad with love and began to dance, and he became foremost among Vaiṣṇavas.

233 Absorbed in ecstasy, the Lord asked Śrīvāsa for His flute, and Śrīvāsa said, "The gopīs have stolen Your flute."

234 At this the Lord cried in ecstasy, "Tell Me! Tell Me!", and Śrīvāsa began to describe the rasa of the pastimes of Vṛndāvana.

235 First he described the sweetness of Vṛndāvana, and as the Lord listened, the joy in His heart grew.

236 Again and again the Lord said, “Tell Me! Tell Me!”, and again and again Śrīvāsa told it, at ever greater length:

237 how the sound of the flute drew the gopīs to the forest, and how Kṛṣṇa wandered there with them all;

238 and within that he described the pastimes of the six seasons, and told of the drinking of madhu, the festival of the rāsa dance and the play in the water.

239 “Tell Me! Tell Me!” said the Lord, delighting in all He heard, and then Śrīvāsa told of the rāsa dance and its play of rasa.[62]

240 So, telling and hearing, they passed the night until morning came, and the Lord embraced Śrīvāsa and filled him with joy.

241 Then, in the house of Ācārya Candraśekhara, He enacted Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes, and the Lord Himself took the forms of Rukmiṇī and others.[63]

242 At times He became Durgā or Lakṣmī, at times the spiritual potency (*cit-śakti*) herself; and seated on the couch, He gave the devotees loving devotion.[64]

243 One day, when Mahāprabhu’s dancing had ended, a brāhmaṇa woman came and clasped His feet.[65]

244 Again and again she took the dust of His feet, and seeing this, the Lord was overcome with sorrow.

245 At once the Lord ran and threw Himself into the Ganges; Nityānanda and Haridāsa caught hold of Him and brought Him out.

246 That night He stayed in the house of Vijaya Ācārya, and in the morning the devotees all took Him home.

247 One day, sitting at home in the mood of a gopī, the Lord was calling "Gopī! Gopī!", sunk in sorrow.

248 A student came to see the Lord and, hearing Him call "Gopī! Gopī!", began to say:

249 "Why do You not chant the name of Kṛṣṇa? Kṛṣṇa's name is blessed. What merit is there in saying 'Gopī! Gopī!'?"

250 Hearing this, the Lord in anger heaped reproaches on Kṛṣṇa, and He took up a stick and rose to beat the student.[66]

251 The student fled in terror with the Lord running after him, until in great haste the devotees held the Lord back.

252 They calmed Him and brought Him back to His house, while the student ran off to the gathering of the students.

253 Going to the place where a thousand students studied together, the young brāhmaṇa told them what had happened with the Lord.

254 At this the whole crowd of students grew angry, and together they all began to revile the Lord:

255 "Nimāi alone has corrupted the whole land. He wants to beat a brāhmaṇa — He has no fear of dharma!

256 If He does such a thing again, we shall beat Him. Who is He, after all? What can He do?"

257 By blaspheming the Lord they all lost their intelligence, and the learning they had studied so well no longer shone in any of them.[67]

258 Even so, the proud students did not become humble; wherever they went they laughed and spoke ill of the Lord.

259 The all-knowing Lord knew their plight, and sitting at home He pondered how they might be delivered:

260 "All these teachers and their disciples are given to ritual duty, fruitive work and austerity — yet they are blasphemers and wicked men.

261 Because of their offence of blaspheming Me, they cannot take up devotion unless I Myself lead them to it.

262 I came to deliver them, and the very opposite has happened. How can any good come to these wicked men?[68]

263 If they bow down to Me, their sins will be destroyed, and then, if I lead them to devotion, they will take it up.

264 Those who blaspheme Me and will not bow to Me — all these souls I must surely deliver.

265 So I shall certainly take sannyāsa; then, taking Me for a sannyāsī, they will bow down to Me.[69]

266 By bowing down they will be freed from their offences, and in their purified hearts I shall make devotion arise.

267 Then these unbelievers will be delivered. There is no other way — this is the best plan."

268 Having made this firm resolve, the Lord remained at home. Then Keśava Bhāratī came to the town of Nadia.

269 The Lord bowed to him and invited him, and when He had fed him, He made His request:

270 "You are Īśvara indeed — Nārāyaṇa Himself. Be merciful and set Me free from saṁsāra."

271 Bhāratī said, "You are Īśvara, the Lord who dwells within all hearts. Whatever You say I shall do; I am not my own master."

272 With these words Bhāratī Gosāñi went to Kāṭoyā, and Mahāprabhu went there and took sannyāsa.[70]

273 With Him were Nityānanda, Candraśekhara Ācārya and Mukunda Datta, and these three performed all the rites.

274 Thus I have given an outline of the Ādi-līlā; Vṛndāvana dāsa has described it in detail.[71]

275 The son of Yaśodā has become the son of Śacī, and He tastes the four kinds of His devotees' moods.[72]

276 To taste His own sweetness and the rasa of Rādhā's love, He has fully made Rādhā's mood His own.[73]

277 The Lord has wholly taken on the gopīs' mood, in which they hold the son of Vraja's king as their own beloved.

278 And this is the firm certainty of the gopīs' love: it does not arise for anyone but the son of the king of Vraja —

279 Śyāmasundara, adorned with a peacock feather and guñjā beads, in a cowherd's dress, His body bent in three places, the flute at His lips.

280 If Kṛṣṇa leaves this form and takes another, the gopīs' love does not come near Him.

281 "What wise man can fathom the ways of the gopīs' love for the son of the cowherd king — a love that moves on a path beyond comprehension? For even when He reveals a form of Viṣṇu, wondrous in its splendour, with four victorious arms, their love, alas, shrinks back." (Lalita-mādhava, 6.14)[74]

282 In spring, as Kṛṣṇa was dancing the rāsa by Govardhana, He made a sign to Rādhā and disappeared.

283 He sat in a secluded bower watching the path for Rādhā, and a troop of gopīs came there searching for Him.

284 Seeing Kṛṣṇa from afar, the gopīs cried, "Look, there in the bower is the son of Vraja's king!"

285 Seeing the gopīs, Kṛṣṇa was alarmed; He could not hide, and fear overcame Him.

286 So He took a four-armed form and sat there, and seeing Kṛṣṇa thus, the gopīs came near and said,

287 "This is not Kṛṣṇa; this is a form of Nārāyaṇa." So saying, they all bowed to Him and offered praise:

288 “Obeisance to Nārāyaṇa! O Lord, be gracious: grant us Kṛṣṇa’s company and take away our sorrow.”

289 With these words they bowed and went away, and just then Rādhā came into view.

290 Seeing Rādhā, Kṛṣṇa wanted to keep that four-armed form, to tease Her as well.

291 But before Rādhā two of His arms vanished; try as He might, Kṛṣṇa could not keep them.

292 Such is the inconceivable power of Rādhā’s pure love, which brought Kṛṣṇa back to His own two-armed nature.

293 “At the start of the rāsa dance Kṛṣṇa hid in a bower, but the doe-eyed gopīs saw Him; to conceal Himself, He cleverly showed them a four-armed form. Yet before the splendour of Rādhā’s love even the all-powerful Hari could not keep it. Ah, how great is Her love!” (Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi)[75]

294 He who was the king of Vraja is here Jagannātha, the father; she who was the queen of Vraja is here Śacīdevī, the mother.

295 He who was Nanda’s son is here Caitanya Gosāñi; He who was Baladeva is here Nityānanda, His brother.

296 Filled with three moods — parental love, servitude and friendship — Nityānanda is the helper of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya.[76]

297 Giving prema-bhakti, He flooded the world; people cannot understand His wondrous ways.

298 Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi is the incarnation as a devotee (*bhakta-avatāra*); He brought Kṛṣṇa down and preached devotion.[77]

299 Friendship and servitude are His two natural moods, and at times the Lord treats Him as His guru.

300 Śrīvāsa and all the other devotees of Mahāprabhu serve Caitanya, each in his own mood.

301 Paṇḍita Gosāñi and the others — whatever each one's rasa, in that very rasa the Lord comes under his control.[78]

302 There He is Śyāma, the flute at His lips, sporting as a cowherd boy; here He is Gaura — at times a brāhmaṇa, at times a sannyāsī.

303 Therefore the Lord Himself, taking on the mood of the gopīs, calls the son of Vraja's king "Lord of My life".[79]

304 He is Kṛṣṇa, and He is a gopī — a supreme contradiction! The Lord's inconceivable ways are very hard to understand.[80]

305 Let no one raise doubts about this by argument: such is Kṛṣṇa's inconceivable potency.

306 Inconceivable and wondrous are the pastimes of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya — wondrous His moods, wondrous His qualities, wondrous His ways.

307 The wicked man who rejects this by argument rots in Kumbhīpāka, with no way out.[81]

308 "What is inconceivable should not be put to the test of argument. And what lies beyond material nature — that is the mark of the inconceivable."

(Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 2.5.93)[82]

309 Whoever has faith in Caitanya's wondrous pastimes comes to His feet.

310 In the course of the story I have told the essence of this conclusion; whoever hears it attains pure devotion.

311 When I restate what the book has already told, the reader comes to taste its meaning.

312 So it is Vyāsa's way in the Bhāgavatam: as he tells the story, he restates it again and again.[83]

313 So now I shall count the chapters of the Ādi-līlā. In the first chapter I made the "auspicious invocation";

314 the second chapter is the "determining of the truth of Caitanya": He who is Svayam Bhagavān, the son of Vraja's king,

315 is Caitanya-Kṛṣṇa, the son of Śacī. The third chapter gives the "general" cause of His birth,

316 and within it the "special" cause, the gift of prema; the religion of the age is the preaching of Kṛṣṇa's name and of prema.

317 In the fourth I told the "root" cause of His birth: to taste the blissful rasa of love for His own sweetness.

318 The fifth determines the truth of Śrī Nityānanda: Nityānanda was Rāma, the son of Rohiṇī.

319 The sixth chapter considers the truth of Advaita: Advaita Ācārya is the avatāra of Mahā-Viṣṇu.

320 The seventh chapter gives the account of the Pañca-tattva — how the five truths together gave away prema.

321 The eighth gives the reason for describing Caitanya's pastimes and tells the great glory of a single name of Kṛṣṇa.

322 The ninth describes the wish-fulfilling tree of devotion, which Śrī Caitanya, the gardener, planted.

323 The tenth counts the branches of the main trunk and tells how all the branches gave out the fruit.

324 The eleventh gives the account of Nityānanda's branches, and the twelfth describes the branches of Advaita's trunk.

325 The thirteenth gives the account of Mahāprabhu's birth — how the Lord was born amid the chanting of Kṛṣṇa's name.

326 The fourteenth gives some account of the childhood pastimes, and the fifteenth tells of the boyhood pastimes in brief.

327 In the sixteenth I gave an outline of the pastimes of youth, and in the seventeenth I told especially of the pastimes of young manhood.

328 These are the seventeen chapters of the Ādi-līlā; twelve of them form the preface to the book.

329 In five chapters I have told the deeds of the five ages, very briefly, without going into detail.[84]

330 Vṛndāvana dāsa has described all this in detail in the *Caitanya-maṅgala*, by the strength of Nityānanda's order.[85]

331 The pastimes of Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya are wondrous and endless; even Brahmā, Śiva and Śeṣa cannot reach their end.[86]

332 Whoever tells or hears any part of them is blessed; soon Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya will meet him —

333 Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, Advaita and Nityānanda, Śrīvāsa, Gadādhara and the whole host of devotees.

334 All the devotees who dwell in Vṛndāvana — humbly I place the feet of them all upon my head.

335–336 Placing on my head the feet of Śrī Svarūpa, Śrī Rūpa, Śrī Sanātana, Śrī Raghunātha dāsa and Śrī Jīva, I bow to them, and ever hoping for their mercy, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.[87]

Notes

1. *Anubhāṣya*: the *yavanas* are the mlecchas, those outside Vedic society; devoted to chanting the name, they behave like the good (*sumanasaḥ*). The Lord's deeds are free (*svaira*) and wondrous — not of this world, and beyond the rules of the smārtas. ↩
2. *Anubhāṣya*: young manhood — once the fifteenth year was past; learning — knowledge of the supreme truth; enjoyment — of garments, garlands, sandal paste and the like; the Lord gave the name of Kṛṣṇa together with love (prema). ↩
3. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: having finished His studies and His teaching, Gauracandra, in order to preach pure devotion, for a time feigned this illness; everywhere He explained the name of Kṛṣṇa to His pupils, showed Kṛṣṇa in every rule of grammar, and tried to turn them away from study. *Anubhāṣya*: see *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Ādi 12. ↩
4. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Mahāprabhu went to Gayā with His pupils to offer śrāddha for His father. On the way He fell ill with fever and was cured by drinking the water that had washed the feet of brāhmaṇas, showing

householders that brāhmaṇas must be honoured. In Gayā He received initiation into the Kṛṣṇa mantra from Śrī Īśvara Purī, and from then on His prema began to show itself; returning to Navadvīpa, He began to preach it. ↩

5. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Mother Śacī had offended Śrī Advaita Ācārya, and Mahāprabhu said that until Advaita forgave her she would not receive prema. When Advaita came, Śacī took the dust of his feet and was forgiven. At that time Advaita asked to see the universal form once shown to Arjuna, and the Lord granted his prayer. ↩
6. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the devotees bathed the Lord in Śrīvāsa's house; Mahāprabhu sat on the couch of Viṣṇu (*viṣṇu-khaṭṭā*) and revealed the majesty of the King of kings; Advaita and others worshipped Him, and He granted each the boon he desired. ↩
7. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu was born in the village of Ekacakrā in Bīrbhūm, the son of Hāḍāi Paṇḍita and Padmāvatī. While still a boy He left with a sannyāsī, travelled through many lands and lived long in Mathurā; drawn by Mahāprabhu, He came to Navadvīpa and stayed in the house of Nandana Ācārya, from where the Lord and His devotees brought Him to their own place. ↩
8. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: on the night before the Vyāsa-pūjā, during kīrtana in Śrīvāsa's house, Mahāprabhu, in the mood of Balarāma, sat on the couch of Viṣṇu and asked Nityānanda for the plough and the club, and the devotees saw them in His hands. ↩
9. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Śacī saw this in a dream: Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma, the two Deities of her house, were snatching the offerings with Gaurāṅga and Nityānanda. The next day, as Viśvambhara and Nityānanda were eating in her house, she saw before her eyes that they were Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma. ↩
10. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: on that day Mahāprabhu sat on the couch of Viṣṇu in Śrīvāsa's house; the devotees bathed Him with Ganges water, reciting the *Puruṣa-sūkta*, and offered Him many foods. For seven praharas He showed the moods of all the avatāras, revealed to the devotees the secrets of their past, removed their doubts and granted boons. This is called the *sāta-prahariyā bhāva*, "the mood of seven praharas", or the *mahā-prakāśa*, "the great revelation". ↩
11. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: crying "Boar! Boar!", the Lord entered Murāri Gupta's house in the form of Varāha, lifted a water pot with His teeth, as Varāha lifted the earth, and drank. On another day He climbed onto Murāri's shoulders and danced for a long time. ↩

12. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Śuklāmbara Brahmacārī lived in Navadvīpa on the bank of the Ganges. Once, while the Lord was dancing, he came with his bag of begged rice, and Mahāprabhu, out of love for His devotee, took the rice from his bag and ate it with great love. ↩
13. *Anubhāṣya*: see Ādi 7.76. ↩
14. *Anubhāṣya*: lower than grass — lower in every way, free of worldly pride; more tolerant even than a tree; seeking no honour — giving up worldly honour even when one deserves it; offering honour — to everyone, even the unworthy. With these qualities one should always, at every time, sing the name of Hari with lips and tongue. ↩
15. *Anubhāṣya*: the thread is the holy name, and what is strung on it are the four qualities of this verse: humility, tolerance, freedom from pride and honouring others. With worldly pride one cannot chant constantly; free of these four kinds of pride, the pure soul can always chant, and by obeying this command one surely attains the feet of Kṛṣṇa. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: one who chants without this qualification gets only a semblance of the name (*nāmābhāsa*) or commits an offence against it (*nāmāparādha*), and does not attain its fruit, love for Kṛṣṇa. ↩
16. *Anubhāṣya*: the story of Gopāla Cāpāla is not found in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*. ↩
17. *Anubhāṣya*: the worship of Bhavānī is not the act of a Vaiṣṇava. By condemning it the Lord taught that a worldly, mixed (*viddha*) Vaiṣṇava, who at heart holds to many lords and favours the worship of many gods, is bad company. ↩
18. *Anubhāṣya*: Kuliyā is the present town of Navadvīpa on the western bank of the Ganges; in Mahāprabhu's time Navadvīpa (Antardvīpa, today's Śrī Māyāpura) lay on the eastern bank. The Kuliyā near Kāñcaḍāpāḍā is not the place where offences were forgiven. ↩
19. In the edition this verse is misnumbered "62". ↩
20. *Anubhāṣya*: whoever thinks the Lord, the master of māyā, subject to curses, to Yama's punishment and to the fruits of karma, as a jīva is, invites unbelief; but whoever knows Him as the Supreme Lord, eternally to be served, is freed from the jīva's beginningless aversion to Kṛṣṇa. ↩
21. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: on the day of the *mahā-prakāśa* Mukunda Datta was left outside the door. The Lord said He would not soon be pleased with him, for among devotees Mukunda spoke of pure devotion, while among Māyāvādīs he accepted the Māyāvāda of the *Yoga-vāsiṣṭha*. Hearing this, Mukunda said, "I am fortunate, for some day He will surely show me mercy!"

Seeing how firmly Mukunda had given up the company of Māyāvādīs, the Lord at once called him in, punished him for that association, and gave him His grace — the fruit of the company of pure devotees. ↩

22. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: Advaita Ācārya was a godbrother of Īśvara Purī, Mahāprabhu's guru, so the Lord honoured Him as a guru, though Advaita was His servant. Grieved by this, Advaita went to Śāntipura and began to explain the path of knowledge to some unfortunate people, in order to be punished. Hearing of it, the Lord came to Śāntipura in anger and gave Him a sound beating. Advaita began to dance: "Today my wish is fulfilled! Mahāprabhu grudgingly honoured me as His guru; today He has treated me as His servant and disciple and saved me from the evil of Māyāvāda." Seeing this, the Lord was abashed and was pleased with Him. *Anubhāṣya*: this event is not in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*. ↩
23. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Lord asked Murāri Gupta, a worshipper of Rāma, to recite a hymn to Śrī Rāma, and Murāri recited the *Rāmāṣṭaka* with great love. Then the Lord wrote on his forehead: "By My grace, be Rāmadāsa." *Anubhāṣya*: according to the *Caitanya-maṅgala*, the Lord placed His foot on Murāri's head and showed him His form as Rāma. ↩
24. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: on the night of the first city kīrtana, after the Kazi had been delivered, Chand Kazi came with the kīrtana as far as Śrīdhara's courtyard. There, when the kīrtana stopped to rest, Mahāprabhu mercifully drank the water from Śrīdhara's cracked iron pot, calling it "water offered by a devotee". The place, to the north-east of Māyāpura, is still called the resting place of the kīrtana. ↩
25. The edition's heading calls this "the enactment (*abhinaya*) of freeing Śacī from offence". *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: on the day of the *mahā-prakāśa* Mahāprabhu embraced Haridāsa, declared him an incarnation of Prahlāda and granted him a boon. Mother Śacī had blamed Advaita Ācārya for Viśvarūpa's sannyāsa; Mahāprabhu freed her from this offence against a Vaiṣṇava by having her take the dust of the Ācārya's feet. ↩
26. *Anubhāṣya*: to think the glory of the holy name, which is not different from Kṛṣṇa, an exaggeration (*arthavāda*) — something unreal — is sheer unbelief, opposition to the Lord. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: this is an offence against the name, and no offence is more terrible; on seeing the face of one who offends the name, one should bathe in one's clothes. ↩
27. *Anubhāṣya*: yoga — restraint, observances, posture, breath control and the rest; sāṅkhya — the enumeration of the elements of existence taught by Kapila

(*Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: knowledge that identifies the self with Brahman); dharma — varṇāśrama-dharma; renunciation — sannyāsa. ↩

28. *Anubhāṣya*: Mahāprabhu told Murāri, “By your loving devotion you have brought Kṛṣṇa under your control,” and Murāri replied with the verse of the brāhmaṇa Sudāmā. His humble meaning was: “I have no power to control Kṛṣṇa; it is Kṛṣṇa who, out of love for His devotees, makes an unworthy servant fortunate.” ↩
29. The edition’s heading gives *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.81.14 (a different numbering of the chapter’s verses). *Anubhāṣya* (after the *Vaiṣṇava-toṣaṇī*): Sudāmā marvels that Kṛṣṇa embraced him only because he was born a brāhmaṇa, not out of friendship, of which he thought himself unworthy; thus the Lord’s reverence for brāhmaṇas is glorified. ↩
30. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: one day, tired during the city kīrtana, the Lord came to the courtyard of a devotee and planted a mango seed there; at once the fruit ripened, and a mango festival began. The place is now known as Āmraghaṭṭa (Āmghāṭā). *Anubhāṣya*: this event is not in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*. ↩
31. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: one day Mahāprabhu was holding saṅkīrtana far from home when great storm clouds gathered. The Lord willed them to go, and they scattered at once. That sandbank of the Ganges was therefore called Megher Car, “the Sandbank of the Clouds”; since the river has changed its course, it now lies by the village of Belpukhuriyā. ↩
32. The edition’s heading: “The Lord reveals that He is a cowherd.” *Anubhāṣya*: these are the Lord’s confidential words; the story of the astrologer is not in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*. ↩
33. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: once Baladeva, angry with the Yamunā, dragged her to Himself with His plough. When Mahāprabhu, in the mood of Baladeva, cried “Bring honey!”, everyone saw that pastime. The *Anubhāṣya* cites the account of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.65.25–33): having drunk *vāruṇī*, Balarāma called the Yamunā to play in her waters, and when she did not come, He dragged her with His plough in anger, until she fell trembling at His feet. ↩
34. The edition’s heading names him Candraśekhara Ācāryaratna. ↩
35. *Anubhāṣya*: according to the *Caitanya-maṅgala*, Vanamālī was a brāhmaṇa from East Bengal who saw the Lord in the form of Balarāma, plough in hand. Vanamālī Paṇḍita (Ādi 10.73) also saw a golden plough and club in the Lord’s hands; whether they are the same person is unclear. ↩
36. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: when He began to preach the name in the town, the Lord first told the people living near Śrīvāsa’s courtyard to chant the name of

Hari, clapping their hands; then mṛdaṅgas and karatālas began to sound, and from that time the saṅkīrtana spread from door to door. ↩

37. *Anubhāṣya*: the Kazi was the *faujdār* (district magistrate), Chand Kazi. In those days the zamindars collected the land revenue, while justice and government were in the hands of the kazis; both were under the *subādār* of Bengal. Chand Kazi is said to have been the teacher of Husain Shah, the Nawab of Bengal; by some accounts his name was Maulana Sirajuddin, by others Habibur Rahman. His descendants still live at the same place, and his tomb is there. ↩
38. *Anubhāṣya*: the place, in Śrī Māyāpura, is still called Khol-bhāṅgār Ḍāṅgā, "the place where the drum was broken". ↩
39. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: from the coming of Bakhtiyar Khilji until Chand Kazi, Hindu ways had been greatly suppressed in Navadvīpa; those who truly believed would say "Hari, Hari" once in secret and fall silent. ↩
40. *Caitanya-maṅgala* is the original title of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (cf. Ādi 8.33–35). *Anubhāṣya*: see *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya 23. ↩
41. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the old house of the kazis still stands in one part of the village of Brāhmaṇa-puṣkariṇī; adjoining its other part is Tāraṇavāsa, formerly Bilva-puṣkariṇī. Since this was one village, Chand Kazi and Mahāprabhu were reckoned kin. *Anubhāṣya*: "Cakravartī" is Nīlāmbara Cakravartī; *cācā* means a paternal uncle. ↩
42. *Anubhāṣya*: the three paths of Islam — *sharia*, *tariqa* and *marifa*. ↩
43. The verse is quoted in the *Malamāsa-tattva* (so the edition's heading). *Anubhāṣya*: the horse sacrifice is a particular sacrifice in which a horse is slain; the cow sacrifice is the *gomedha*; sannyāsa is entering the fourth āśrama; the husband's brother is his younger brother. ↩
44. *Anubhāṣya*: "mistaken" — approving needless violence to living beings; absorbed in the "second", in what is apart from the Lord, his understanding was clouded. ↩
45. *Anubhāṣya*: "recent" — new, arisen in time, not of divine origin like the Vedas; "cannot stand up to reasoning" — they do not establish eternal truth and are easily refuted. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: all these books have a beginning; none is beginningless like the word of the Vedas, and so their arguments, lacking a firm root, are open to doubt. ↩
46. *Anubhāṣya*: "invented" — born of the mind, and therefore not eternal truth; "community" (*jāti*) — belonging to one's own community and loyalty to it. ↩

47. *Anubhāṣya*: unsound reasoning — such as can easily be refuted by argument. ↩
48. *Anubhāṣya*: the man's body with a lion's face is Śrī Nṛsiṁhadeva, who destroys enmity towards the devotees, towards bhakti and towards the Lord — and those who bear it. The edition's heading: "Terror from Nṛsiṁhadeva in a dream". ↩
49. *Anubhāṣya*: *piyādā* — a servant of the lowest rank, a messenger; in common speech, a *chaprasi*. ↩
50. *Anubhāṣya* gives the definition: "One who eats beef, says much that is contrary to the Vedas and is devoid of all good conduct is called a *mleccha*." ↩
51. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: though the Pādśāh is your kinsman, he can still punish you; the Pādśāh is Husain Shah, the ruler of Gauḍa. *Anubhāṣya*: Ala-ud-din Saiyad Husain Shah, at that time the independent ruler of Bengal. ↩
52. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Muslim mocked them thus: "Some of you are Kṛṣṇadāsas, some Rāmadāsas and Haridāsas, and you keep saying 'Hari! Hari!' — but *hari* also means 'I steal', so you must be planning to rob someone." From the day he made this jest, his tongue has been saying "Hari! Hari!" against his will. ↩
53. *Anubhāṣya*: mockery (*parihāsa*) is one of the four kinds of *nāmābhāsa*: "The name of Vaikuṇṭha, uttered to indicate something else, in jest, to fill out a song, or with contempt, destroys all sins" (Bhāg. 6.2.14). *Nāmābhāsa* is not the mere sounding of letters: it points to the eternal Reality and awakens the remembrance of Viṣṇu; it destroys worldly desire, and then the liberated soul, turned towards service, gains the right to chant the pure name. ↩
54. *Anubhāṣya*: the *pāṣaṇḍīs* are those sunk in ritual (*karma-jaḍa*), worshippers of many gods, hostile to Viṣṇu and the Vaiṣṇavas, idolaters. ↩
55. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: "the low rise" — He chants Kṛṣṇa's name with many people of low caste, and so the low castes are rising. ↩
56. *Anubhāṣya*: these worshippers of many gods saw the Lord and His name as no more than a part of ritual. Not knowing the boundless generosity of Kṛṣṇa's name, and dazzled by worldly rank and birth, they thought it a sin for the low-born to take the name of Kṛṣṇa, and they ranked the great mantra of the name, which is to be sung at all times, with mantras for silent repetition — as if, once heard by all, it would lose its power; whereas, when it comes upon the tongue and into the ear, it reveals its matchless majesty and delivers all, from Brahmā down to a blade of grass. ↩

57. *Anubhāṣya* on 217–218: *nāmābhāsa* had arisen in the Kazi's mouth (the edition's heading: "*Nāmābhāsa* destroys sin"). ↩
58. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *talāk* — a solemn oath. *Anubhāṣya*: to this day the Kazi's descendants join in the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa and raise no objection to it. ↩
59. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: one night, while Mahāprabhu was holding kīrtana in Śrīvāsa's courtyard, Śrīvāsa's son died. So as not to break the joy of the kīrtana, Śrīvāsa forbade his household to mourn, and Mahāprabhu danced until late in the night. When He learnt of the death, the Lord was grieved that He had not been told at once, and He asked the dead child why he was leaving Śrīvāsa. The boy answered: "I have lived in Śrīvāsa's house for as many days as were ordained; now, by Your will, I go elsewhere. I am Your eternally dependent soul and can do nothing beyond Your will." Hearing this, Śrīvāsa's family received divine knowledge, and their grief was gone. The Lord said to Śrīvāsa: "The son you had has left you, but Nityānanda and I are your eternal sons; We shall never leave you." *Anubhāṣya*: see *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya 25. ↩
60. *Anubhāṣya*: see *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya 10. According to the edition's heading, Nārāyaṇī was the daughter of Śrīvāsa's brother. ↩
61. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the Muslim tailor lived nearby and sewed Śrīvāsa's clothes. One day he watched Mahāprabhu's dancing with faith and was enchanted, and the Lord revealed to him the spiritual nature of His form. *Āgala* (232) means "first, foremost". ↩
62. *Anubhāṣya* on 235–239: it is especially worth noting that Śrīvāsa described Kṛṣṇa's *madhura* (*śṛṅgāra*) rasa with the gopīs of Vraja. ↩
63. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: one night, in the house of Candraśekhara Ācāryaratna, the Lord took the forms of Rukmiṇī and others and enacted a play of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes; Advaita, Haridāsa and many others also appeared in various costumes. *Anubhāṣya*: see *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya 18. ↩
64. *Anubhāṣya*: the Lord appeared in the guise of Ādyā-śakti (see *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya 18). ↩
65. *Anubhāṣya* on 243–246: this incident is not found in the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*. ↩
66. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: *doṣodgāra* — reproach mixed with mockery. *Anubhāṣya* on 247–263: the Lord's anger at Kṛṣṇa and His reproaches in the mood of a gopī are not of this world. Failing to understand this, a student, a smārta sunk in ritual, argued with Him, and the Lord, filled with the gopīs' mood, took him for a partisan of Kṛṣṇa and chased him in anger. The student fled; and brāhmaṇas by birth, sunk in ritual and turned away from Hari,

conspired in their delusion to beat the Lord. To free them from this calamity the Lord resolved to accept the fourth āśrama, which is honoured even by those proud of their birth and caste. See *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya 25. ↩

67. *Anubhāṣya*: the true meaning of the śruti is revealed only to one who has supreme devotion to God and the same devotion to the guru (Śvetāśvatara Upaniṣad, 6.23). Prahlāda says that the best learning is when a person first offers himself to Viṣṇu and then serves Him (Bhāg. 7.5.24, with Śrīdhara Svāmī's comment). But one who, proud of worldly learning, disregards Viṣṇu finds that knowledge does not dawn in him: a master of the Vedas who is not devoted to the Supreme labours in vain (Bhāg. 11.11.18). ↩
68. *Anubhāṣya* quotes the Lord's words from the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Madhya 25): "I gave pippali to cure the phlegm, but the phlegm in the body only grew worse." ↩
69. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: when a brāhmaṇa takes sannyāsa according to the śāstra, everyone — householders and brāhmaṇas alike — bows to him, knowing that a sannyāsī is worthy of homage: "When I take sannyāsa, the blaspheming brāhmaṇas will surely bow to Me and receive a good understanding from Me." *Anubhāṣya* on 265–266: in those days even brāhmaṇas by birth of godless nature bowed before a Vaiṣṇava sannyāsī — such was good custom; and by the śāstra, one who sees the Deity or a Vaiṣṇava *tridaṇḍī* and does not bow must perform atonement or purify himself by fasting. ↩
70. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: at the close of His twenty-fourth year, in the bright fortnight of the month of Māgha, on the day of the saṅkrānti, before dawn, Mahāprabhu left Navadvīpa, swam across the Ganges at the Nidayā ghāṭa and reached Kāṭoyā (Kaṇṭaka-nagara), where He accepted the (single) daṇḍa from Keśava Bhāratī. At the Lord's wish Candraśekhara Ācāryaratna performed the rites of sannyāsa; kīrtana went on all day, and only towards evening was the Lord's head shaved. The next morning Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, staff in hand, set out to wander through Rāḍha-deśa, and Keśava Bhāratī went some way with Him. ↩
71. *Anubhāṣya*: see *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Madhya 26. ↩
72. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the four kinds of devotees' moods are *dāsya*, *sakhya*, *vātsalya* and *madhura* (the edition's heading: "apart from *śānta*"). ↩
73. *Anubhāṣya* on 276–278: Śrī Gaurasundara is Kṛṣṇa clothed in the mood and the radiance of Śrī Rādhā. Therefore He never abandoned the heart's mood of the gopīs headed by Rādhikā, who serve Kṛṣṇa (*āśraya*), to act like Kṛṣṇa the

enjoyer (*viṣaya*): never did He show the ways of a *nāgara* who seeks other men's wives. The *prākṛta-sahajiyās*, who lay their own lust on Gaurasundara, only offend Svarūpa Dāmodara and Vṛndāvana dāsa Ṭhākura. The *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (Ādi 15) says that in this avatāra the Lord would not even hear the word "woman", and that is why the great devotees never praise Him as "Gaurāṅga-nāgara". Thus these verses refute the invented doctrine of *gaura-nāgarī*. ↩

74. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: once Kṛṣṇa playfully revealed the wondrous four-armed form of Nārāyaṇa, and the gopīs' love withdrew; what wise man can understand the moods of the gopīs, who walk the hard path of *parakīya* and serve the son of Nanda alone? *Anubhāṣya*: these are the words of Viśākhā to Savarṇā, the wife of Sūrya; *jiṣṇubhiḥ* — "victorious"; *kuñcati* — "does not blossom". ↩
75. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: at the start of the rāsa Kṛṣṇa playfully hid in a bower; seeing the gopīs approach, He anxiously showed His charming four-armed form, and the ordinary gopīs said, "This is not Kṛṣṇa, our beloved." But how wonderful is the greatness of Rādhā's love: the moment She came, Kṛṣṇa, try as He might, could not keep that form. *Anubhāṣya*: this took place in spring by Govardhana, at the site of the rāsa called Parāsaulī; the gopīs had surrounded the bower, and there was no slipping away unseen. Though the Lord is subject to love, one cannot say that His majesty vanishes before love: it is eternal — it is only concealed. The edition's heading gives *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*, seventh *aṅka*, words of Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī. ↩
76. *Anubhāṣya* on 296–301: these verses show how varied are the wondrous moods of service to Gaura in Nityānanda, Advaita and the others. It quotes the *Gaura-gaṇoddeśa-dīpikā* (11–16): Gauracandra is the son of Nanda in the form of a devotee; Nityānanda is Halāyudha (Balarāma) in the guise of a devotee; Advaita is Sadāśiva, the incarnation as a devotee; Śrīvāsa and the others are devotees; Gadādhara is the devotee-potency (cf. Ādi 7.6). ↩
77. "Bringing Kṛṣṇa down": by His call Advaita brought Kṛṣṇa into this world (cf. Ādi 3). ↩
78. Paṇḍita Gosāñi is Gadādhara Paṇḍita. The edition's heading: "The *śaktis* — Gadādhara, Svarūpa, Rāmānanda, Śrī Rūpa and others — serve Gaura-Kṛṣṇa in *madhura-rasa*." ↩
79. *Anubhāṣya* on 303–304: see 17.276–278. ↩
80. The edition's heading: "Without following the *rūpānugas* one cannot fathom Gaura's rasa of separation (*vipralambha*)." ↩

81. *Anubhāṣya*: Kumbhīpāka is a hell where sinners are cooked in a pot (*kumbhī*); there goes one who cooks animals and birds alive (Bhāg. 5.26.13). The edition's heading: "The fate of the arguer — 'the doubter perishes'" (Bhagavad-gītā, 4.40). ↩
82. *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya*: the mark of the inconceivable is that it lies beyond material nature; argument is material and cannot touch that truth, and so it is not to be applied to what is inconceivable. *Anubhāṣya*: in the *Mahābhārata* this is Sañjaya's reply to Dhṛtarāṣṭra, who wished to hear of the rivers, mountains and forests of the earth; "inconceivable" means beyond the reach of the worldly, pleasure-seeking mind. ↩
83. *Anubhāṣya*: in the twelfth chapter of the last, twelfth canto of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, Vyāsa sums up the whole book from beginning to end in 52 verses; following the path of this *mahājana*, the author likewise recapitulates the Ādi-līlā. ↩
84. *Anubhāṣya*: of the seventeen chapters of the Ādi-līlā, the first twelve are only the preface (*upakramaṇikā*) to the book; chapters thirteen to seventeen tell of the five ages — birth, childhood (*bālya*), boyhood (*paugaṇḍa*), youth (*kaiśora*) and young manhood (*yuvā*). ↩
85. *Caitanya-maṅgala* is the original title of the *Caitanya-bhāgavata* (cf. Ādi 8.33–35). ↩
86. *Anubhāṣya*: cf. Madhya 21.10, 12; Bhāg. 2.7.41, 10.14.7. ↩
87. *Anubhāṣya*: Svarūpa is Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa (see Madhya 10.102–127). Here the edition has the colophon — "Thus, in the *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta*, in the Ādi-khaṇḍa, ends the seventeenth chapter, called 'A Brief Description of the Pastimes of Young Manhood'" — and the words "Thus ends the Ādi-līlā". ↩